of algae include *Ceramium, Polysiphonia, Gelidium, Cryptonemia* and *Gigartina*

DO YOU KNOW?

A green alga *Botryococcus braunii* is employed in Bio-fuel production.

Algae in Health care

Kelps are the rich source of Iodine *Chlorella* is used as single cell Protein (SCP).

Dunaliella salina an alga, growing in salt pan is complement to our health and provide β carotene.

2.3.3 Economic Importance

The Economic importance of Algae is given in Table 2.3

2.3.4 Chara

Class – Chlorophyceae
Order – Charales
Family – Characeae
Genus – *Chara*

Chara is commonly called as ' stone wort' It is a submerged aquatic freshwater alga growing attached to the mud of the lakes and slow running streams. *Chara baltica* grows in saline water. The thallus is often encrusted with calcium and magnesium carbonate.

Thallus structure

The plant body is multicellular, macroscopic and is differentiated into main axis and rhizoids. The rhizoids are thread-like,

Table 2.3: Economic importance of Algae

Name of the Algae	Economic importance
Beneficial activities	
Chlorella, Laminaria, Sargassum, Ulva, Enteromorpha	Food
Gracilaria, Gelidiella, Gigartina	Agar Agar – Cell wall material used for media preparation in the microbiology lab. Packing canned food, cosmetic, textile paper industry
Chondrus crispus	Carrageenan – Preparation of tooth paste, paint, blood coagulant
Laminaria, Ascophyllum	Alginate – ice cream, paints, flame proof fabrics
Laminaria, Sargassum, Ascophyllum, Fucus	Fodder
Diatom (Siliceous frustules)	Diatomaceous earth– water filters, insulation material, reinforcing agent in concrete and rubber.
Lithophyllum, Chara, Fucus	Fertilizer
Chlorella	Chlorellin -Antibiotic
Chlorella, Scenedesmus, Chlamydomonas	Sewage treatment, Pollution indicators
Harmful activity	
Cephaleuros virescens	Red rust of coffee

DO YOU KNOW?

A Productive Cultivation in Sea

Algae like *Kappaphycus alvarezii, Gracilaria edulis* and *Gelidiella acerosa* are commercially grown in the sea for harvesting the phycocolloids.



Sea Palm It is *Postelia palmaeformis* a brown alga.

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